

Psalms 60

Thou Hast Given a Banner

Thou hast given a banner to them that fear thee
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 O God, thou hast cast us off, thou hast scattered us, thou hast been displeased; O turn thyself to us again.
- 2 Thou hast made the earth to tremble; thou hast broken it: heal the breaches thereof; for it shaketh.
- 3 Thou hast shewed thy people hard things: thou hast made us to drink the wine of astonishment.
- 4 Thou hast given a banner to them that fear thee, that it may be displayed because of the truth. Selah.
- 5 That thy beloved may be delivered; save with thy right hand, and hear me.
- 6 God hath spoken in his holiness; I will rejoice, I will divide Shechem, and mete out the valley of Succoth.
- 7 Gilead is mine, and Manasseh is mine; Ephraim also is the strength of mine head; Judah is my lawgiver;
- 8 Moab is my washpot; over Edom will I cast out my shoe: Philistia, triumph thou because of me.
- 9 Who will bring me into the strong city? who will lead me into Edom?
- 10 Wilt not thou, O God, which hadst cast us off? and thou, O God, which didst not go out with our armies?
- 11 Give us help from trouble: for vain is the help of man.
- 12 Through God we shall do valiantly: for he it is that shall tread down our enemies.

2 · CONTEXT

Superscription ties this to David's wars with Syria and Edom (2 Sam 8; 1 Chron 18), specifically a season when Israel suffered an initial setback ("thou hast been displeased... thou hast broken us down") before eventual victory. Henry treats it as a national lament turning into confident claim on God's promises regarding the land. MacArthur-style notes highlight verses 6–8 as God's own oracle asserting sovereign ownership of the tribes and neighboring nations.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-3

"O God, thou hast cast us off, thou hast scattered us... thou hast made the earth to tremble... heal the breaches thereof." National defeat is read theologically as divine displeasure, not mere bad luck, calling for God's own healing of what He has broken.

Verse 4-5

Yet even amid discipline, "Thou hast given a banner to them that fear thee, that it may be displayed because of the truth." A rallying sign of hope is granted so that "thy beloved" may be delivered—chastening does not cancel covenant love.

Verse 6-8

God's own oracle of ownership: "I will divide Shechem... Gilead is mine, and Manasseh is mine... Moab is my washpot... over Philistia will I triumph." Sovereign claim over Israel's tribes and hostile neighbors grounds any hope of victory.

Verse 9-12

The question "Who will bring me into the strong city? who will lead me into Edom?" answers itself: not human strength ("vain is the help of man") but God alone, who alone "shalt tread down our enemies," gives true valor and victory.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

National setbacks under God's discipline do not erase His covenant claims or His banner of hope for those who fear Him; ultimate victory over hostile powers rests entirely on God's sovereign ownership and strength, not human alliance or might.

Application for life today.

When corporate or personal defeat feels like divine displeasure, ask God to "heal the breaches" rather than only analyzing the loss strategically. Look for the "banner" God has given—some sign of hope He grants even amid discipline—and rally around it. Recognize that "vain is the help of man" in your hardest battles; let dependence on God replace confidence in human strategy alone.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. Where have you experienced a setback that felt like discipline, and how might you pray verses 1–3's honest lament?

2. What "banner"—sign of hope or rallying truth—has God given you in a hard season?

3. In what battle are you currently relying on "the help of man" more than on God's promised strength?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).